

WORKSHEET

The word that makes separation

Torah: Genesis 1:1–6:8 · **Haftarah:** 1 Samuel 20:18–42 · **Gospel:** Matthew 24:29–36

*God creates by speaking and separating; the Spirit hovers over the emptiness and the Word calls light and order. Sin is de-creation: the prophets use the image of *tohu va-vohu* for where sin ends up (though linguistically other words than *hevel/riq*). Cain grasps and lets sin rule; Jonathan — “the LORD has given” — receives and gives. Ruling over sin succeeds not from our own emptiness but by the Spirit. And when the lights go out, His word remains: “heaven and earth shall pass away, my words shall not” (24:35).*

How to use this sheet

Work from top to bottom: first observe (A1), then weigh (A2), then diagnose (A3), and only then summarise (A4). The direction — receiving or grasping — is the horizon, not the starting point.

Basic data

Parashah / scope: Bereshit — Genesis 1:1–6:8. Haftarah (Machar Chodesh): 1 Samuel 20:18–42. Flanking reading and status: Matthew 24:29–36 — New Testament reflection, used confessionally (not as peshat). Audience: study group / congregation.

A1. Text blocks and peshat

Block	What it says (peshat)	Keywords / contrast	Open question
Gen. 1	Creating by speaking; light and God said · before the lights; all “good”. good		On what does the world rest?

Gen. 2–3	The garden given; “she took and ate”; break and thorns.	gift ↔ grasp	What breaks first?
Gen. 4–6:8	Death (“and he died”); God’s grief; Noah found grace.	death · chen	Does it end in judgment or grace?
1 Sam. 20:18–42	New moon; Jonathan’s loyalty; covenant across the parting.	new moon · covenant remains	What remains when ways divide?
Matt. 24:29–36	Lights go out; “heaven and earth pass, my words not”.	go out · word remains	On what do you hang?

A2. Connecting hypotheses

Hypothesis 1 (one axis): the centre is receiving vs grasping alone — creation as gift, fall as grasp.

Hypothesis 2 (relation): the centre is Source ↔ Trajectory — the creating word that also remains (Matt. 24:35), from “in the beginning... and God said” to “my words shall not pass,” with gift, grasp, death and grace along the way.

Which explains the most data with the least strain? Hypothesis 2. It explains why the lights (1:14) and the new moon (haftarah) and their going-out (Matt. 24) cohere, and why the ending is grace (6:8). Hypothesis 1 leaves haftarah and gospel dangling.

What would refute this reading? If the word did not return as a constant (Matt. 24:35) and the lights/new moon played no part, the weight would lie with the one axis.

A3. Four axes

Axis	Text anchors	Diagnosis	Open anomaly
Source	1:3 · 6:8 · Matt. 24:35	Load-bearing. The creating, remaining word; ending in	Light before the light-sources?

grace.

	1:1 → 3:6 → 5	Load-bearing. Beginning →	
Trajectory	→ 6:8 → Matt. 24	fall → death → grace → end; moon wanes and renews.	De-creation or fulfilment?
Coherence	1:29-30 ↔ 3:6 · Gift ↔ 1 Sam. 20:42	grasp; covenant word remains.	Where does receiving become grasp?
Will	3:6 · Matt. 24:42	Response: hearing and abiding, or grasping and falling.	Watching: reckoning or trusting?

A4. Movement

What is unmasked? The grasp: taking what you were given to receive, wanting to be as God apart from the Giver (3:6) — the primal form of all evil, and trusting in the made which passes away.

What frame does the text put in its place? The creating word that is gift and remains: receive the world from His hand, and hang your life on the word that does not pass away (Matt. 24:35).

What concrete response and formation follow? Receiving again instead of grasping; leaving the appointed times to the Father (the hour He alone knows); and abiding in the Word, even when the lights go out.

Core sentence: God spoke and it was; man grasped and death came; but grace was found — and the word that created remains as heaven and earth pass away.

Horizon (ground, not the week's theme): the creating word became flesh in Yeshua (John 1:14) and “my words shall not pass away” (Matt. 24:35) — confessional horizon, not peshat-setter.

